Dhaka Housing: Where Demand Can Still Be Served, and How Client Data Guides the Decision

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Part A. Housing market analysis

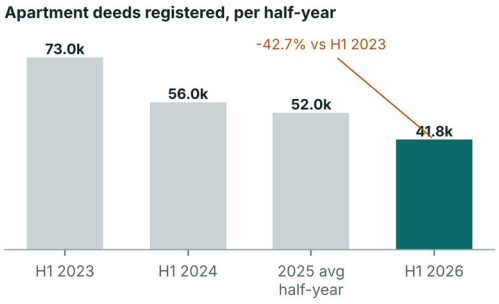
Question. If a Dhaka developer launches a project in the next 12 months, which segment is most likely to sell, and what should it track to avoid stalled inventory?

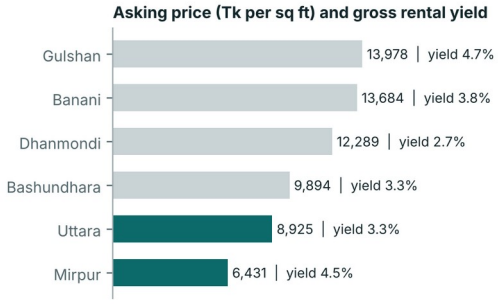
Method. I collected public data from news reports, a market analysis, government survey figures and a central bank decision, recorded each figure with its source and date in one workbook, and built three measures: price and rental yield by area, the registration trend, and the income a household needs to buy. Numbers in square brackets point to the source list at the end.

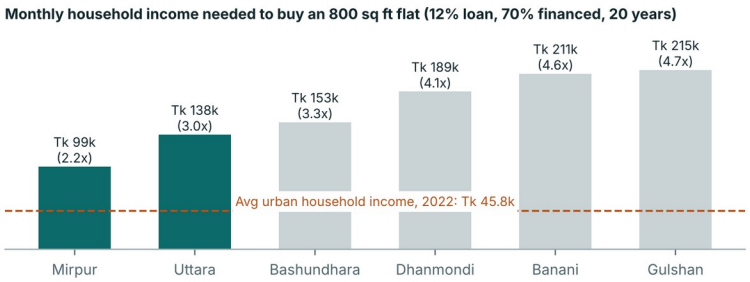
Data collected	Period	Source
Asking price per sq ft and rental yield, 6 areas	2026	[1]
Apartment deeds registered (Directorate of Registration)	2023 to Jun 2026	[2]
Construction costs, new taxes, cancellations	2020 to Jul 2026	[2]
Policy rate and inflation	Jul 2026	[3]
Average urban household income (BBS HIES)	2022	[4]

What the data shows

- **Demand has fallen sharply.** Apartment deeds in Jan to Jun 2026 were 41,804, down 19.6% from the 2025 half-year average, 25.4% from H1 2024 and 42.7% from H1 2023 [2]. Average declared value per deed fell from Tk 68.5 lakh (2023) to Tk 43.1 lakh (H1 2026), which may point to smaller or cheaper purchases (my calculation; declared values are not market prices).
- **Costs and policy press on supply.** Materials are up 50 to 60% since 2020, with cement at Tk 540 to 580 per bag and rods at Tk 85,000 to 1,00,000 per tonne. The FY2026-27 budget adds a 15% capital gains tax on assessed apartment value and a 10% duty on steel and cement [2]. One developer reports about 25% of bookings cancelled since August 2024 [2].
- **Prices differ more than 2x across areas.** Asking prices range from Tk 6,431 per sq ft in Mirpur to Tk 13,978 in Gulshan. Mirpur has the second-highest gross rental yield (4.5%) among the six areas, after Gulshan (4.7%); Dhanmondi has the lowest (2.7%) [1].
- **The binding constraint is affordability.** For an 800 sq ft flat, 70% financed over 20 years at 12%, the EMI would be Tk 39,654 in Mirpur and Tk 86,190 in Gulshan. With EMI kept to 40% of income, the household needs Tk 99,000 to Tk 215,000 a month: 2.2x to 4.7x the 2022 average urban household income of Tk 45,757 [4]. Rates matter: Mirpur's required income is Tk 86,900 at 10% and Tk 112,000 at 14%. The policy rate was cut to 9.5% from 10% on 30 July 2026, while inflation was 9.16% in June [3].







Decision I would recommend to the CEO's Office

1. Lead with compact units (600 to 800 sq ft) in value-priced, transit-served areas such as Mirpur or Uttara. They need the lowest income to buy, and Mirpur's yield (4.5%) also suits investor-buyers. Sources disagree on

Mirpur's price direction (falling in [1], rising near metro stations in [5]), so I would test demand with enquiries before committing the whole project.

2. Build in phases with a pre-sale gate. Start the next phase only after an agreed share of the current phase is booked (I would propose 50%, to be tested against real sales data). One Dhaka project stopped after the third floor with 22 of 48 units sold [2].

3. Be selective in premium areas. Asking prices are still rising in Gulshan and Banani [1], but the new capital gains tax and thin overall demand argue for pre-sales before adding premium inventory.

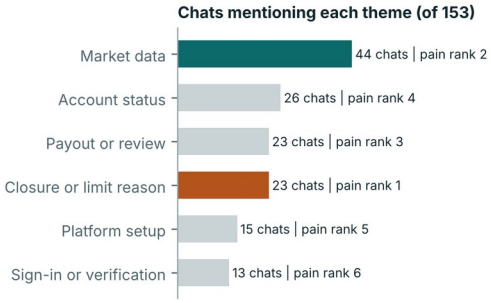
4. Track five indicators monthly: registrations, the policy rate, cement and rod prices, the funnel from enquiry to site visit to booking, and cancellations.

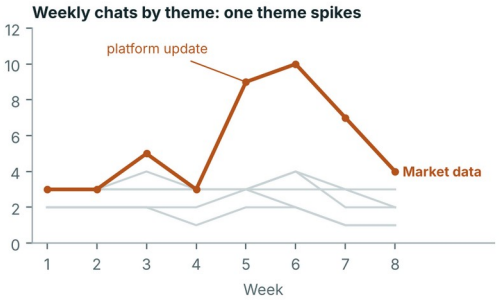
Confidence: medium. Limits: asking prices are not transaction prices; the income figure is from 2022 and has since risen; the 12% loan rate is a scenario (home loans add a bank margin to the 9.65% base rate [6]); and public data cannot show TPHL's own sales funnel.

Part B. Demo project: how chat keywords help a BI team build a better trading platform

Setting (fictional data). A BI team supporting a SaaS trading platform asks: which problems do traders raise most, which hurt most, and what should Product build first? I tested a method on 153 invented chats over 8 weeks. None of it is real client data.

Method. (1) List 5 phrases per theme in a keyword sheet, for example "blank chart" or "no prices" for market data. (2) An Excel formula tags every chat by theme (SEARCH inside SUMPRODUCT). (3) For each theme, count chats and measure handle time, CSAT and repeat contact. (4) Combine them into a simple pain score and rank. (5) Track themes weekly and flag any rise above 1.5x.





What the keywords reveal

- **Volume is not pain.** Market data is the most frequent theme (44 of 153 chats, 29%), but "why was my account closed" and drawdown questions rank first on pain: 23 chats, the longest handle time (17 minutes), the lowest CSAT (2.3 of 5) and a 30% repeat-contact rate. Counting alone would send Product to the wrong place first.
- **An early warning appears.** Market-data chats rise from 3.5 a week (weeks 1-4) to 8.7 a week (weeks 5-7), 2.5x, right after a platform update. A monthly report would show this late; a weekly count flags it in week 5. Payout chats repeat most (35%), because clients cannot see where a request stands.

Recommendation to Product (what to build first). (1) Show the rule hit, balance and drawdown figures in plain words at the moment an account closes. (2) Add a data-feed status banner and a one-click market-data guide, and review the update that triggered the spike. (3) Add a payout tracker with stages and an expected date. (4) Add an account-status page listing every account and its state. Measure each by weekly chats on its theme, repeat contact and CSAT. At assumed reductions of 20 to 40%, this sample saves about 1.3 handling hours a week; real savings need real volume and a pilot.

How this connects to my work. I do the first steps today: I collect what traders say in live chat, use AI to surface recurring keywords, and send a weekly report of pain points and suggestions to the product development team. I also automated a recurring check from 12-15 minutes to 2-3 minutes (Excellence Card). The workbook's Formulas_Used sheet lists every formula behind this demo. At TPHL the same method would run on buyer enquiries (price, payment plan, handover, loans, documents) and feed a weekly note to the CEO's Office.

Sources

[1] Concord CPS, Secondary Real Estate Market Analysis: Dhaka 2026 Trends, 14 Jun 2026 (citing Bproperty 2026 listing data). concordcps.com
[2] The Business Standard, Housing sector sinks deeper amid plunging sales, soaring costs, 16 Jul 2026 (Directorate of Registration data). tbsnews.net
[3] The Daily Star, BB cuts policy rate to 9.5%, 30 Jul 2026. thedailystar.net
[4] The Daily Star, Household income doubles in 6 years, so does spending (BBS HIES 2022), 18 Dec 2023. thedailystar.net
[5] Angan Properties, Flat Prices in Dhaka: Area-Wise Rates & Trends, updated 14 Mar 2026 (cross-check only). angan.com.bd
[6] BRAC Bank, Base rate page (Bangladesh Bank data, Nov 2025). bracbank.com

Prepared in Excel with AI assistance for drafting and for checking calculations. Part A uses public sources; Part B uses invented data only, and no employer or client data is used.